

Kambaiz Rafi, PhD

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EDUCATION

- PhD in Development Policy**, University College London, London, UK 2016 – 2021
Thesis: *Habitus and Embodied Institutions: A Study of Manufacturing Enterprises in Kabul's Conflict-Affected Market Economy and Adaptive Strategies for Enterprise Continuation*
Supervisor: Michael Walls
Examiners: Alexandra Panman and Magnus Marsden
Pass with minor corrections (July 2021)
- MA International Political Economy**, King's College London, London, UK 2012 – 2013
Pass with Merit
- BA Economics**, University of Pune, Pune, India 2007 – 2010
First Class with Distinction
- Diploma in National Security and International Relations**, Deccan Education Society, Pune, India 2009 – 2010
First Class with Distinction

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

- Non-resident Research Fellow**, University of Central Asia Graduate School of Development 2025 –
• Research project: 'Informal social institutions and the reduction of uncertainty in early manufacturing activities'
- Honorary Visiting Fellow**, School of Government and International Affairs, Durham University, Durham, UK 2024
• Completion of article (published in *Third World Quarterly*)
• Completion of manuscript (submitted to *European Journal of Development Research*)
- Teaching Fellow in Comparative Politics of Development**, School of Government and International Affairs, Durham University, Durham, UK 2023 – 2024
• Seminar lecturer, Political Economy of Development, undergraduate module (54 students)
• Assistant lab leader, Quantitative Methods and Analysis, postgraduate module (44 students)
• Lecturer, Quantitative Methods Workshops, undergraduate module (76 students)

- Lecturer, Research Project on Democracy, Good Governance and Development, undergraduate module (25 students)
- Lecturer and convenor, Democratic Political Systems, undergraduate module (83 students)
- Co-leader, Quantitative Labs for Researching Politics and International Relations, undergraduate module (138 students)
- Dissertation supervision, undergraduate (7 students)
- Marking (no. of scripts: approximately 490) and pastoral support

Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Economic and Social Research Council Postdoctoral Fellow), Department of Development Studies, SOAS University of London, London, UK 2022 – 2023

- Published article in *Global Policy Journal*
- Collected and thematically coded documents for a computerised text analysis of International Monetary Fund policy advocacy in postwar contexts
- Launched book ‘Patriarchal Hierarchy’ (events held at UCL, KCL, SOAS, University of Pittsburgh)
- Published op-eds (e.g., The Conversation) and participated in media interviews

Senior Postgraduate Teaching Assistant, Bartlett Development Planning Unit, University College London, London, UK 2020 – 2021

- Tutor, Development in Practice, postgraduate module (student no.: 86)
- Coordinator for the master’s in Development Administration and Planning programme
- Pastoral support, marking, and communication management

Postgraduate Teaching Assistant, Bartlett Development Planning Unit, University College London, London, UK 2017 – 2018

- Tutor, master’s in Urban Economic Development programme
- Research advisor for field research, postgraduate module
- Pastoral support, marking, and formative feedback
- Supervisor of methods for the ‘London Project’

FIELDS Development Economics, Industrial Policy, Formal and Informal Institutions, Digital Development, International Financial Institutions, Postwar Governance

RESEARCH SKILLS Quantitative data analysis and visualisation, computerised mixed-methods text analysis (structured topic modelling), qualitative interviews, thematic analysis, and fieldwork

PUBLICATIONS A) Peer-reviewed journal articles

Rafi, K. (2025). Ograyi and Bourdieusian social capital in Afghanistan's manufacturing sector. *Third World Quarterly*, 46(16): 2178 – 2199
<https://doi.org/10.1080/01436597.2025.2547089>

Rafi, K. (2024). Minimalist economic management, deferred revenue regime and aid dependency: explaining contradictory post-war statebuilding aims. *Global Policy Journal*, 15(5): 869-885
<https://doi.org/10.1111/1758-5899.13427>

Rafi, K. (2018). Information and communication technology in development: a contextual approach. *Indian Journal of Human Development*, 12(3): 453-461
<https://doi.org/10.1177/0973703018800197>

Rafi, K. (2015). The Afghan insurgency and the uncertainty of peace negotiations. *Journal of Perspectives on Terrorism*, 9(5): 69-72
<https://pt.icct.nl/article/policy-brief-afghan-insurgency-and-uncertainty-peace-negotiations>

B) Monograph

Rafi, K. (2022). *Patriarchal Hierarchy; Market Capitalism and Production in Afghanistan*. Cham: Palgrave Macmillan
<https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-98407-6>

C) Work under review

Rafi, K., technology-in-practice: ICT use in Afghanistan's manufacturing sector. Manuscript submitted to The European Journal of Development Research, revisions completed under the journal's Early Career Researcher Initiative (resubmitted on 15th March 2026).

Rafi, K., uncertainty mitigation in an emerging private manufacturing sector (manuscript ready for submission. Submitted to the Review of Development Economics on 27th May.

D) Work in preparation

Rafi, K., the power to constitute: IMF policy role in the early postwar moment. Target journal: Review of International Organisations

Rafi, K., scholastic bias: IMF policy advocacy responsiveness to rising insecurity. Target journal: Review of International Political Economy

Rafi, K., realism or autonomy: IMF policy role post-2014 United States military drawdown from Afghanistan. Target journal: Development and Change

Rafi, K., what does the World Bank mean by ‘Enabling environment’? Target journal: Review of International Political Economy

Rafi, K., formal institutions and administrative state in post-war state-building. Target journal: Human Geography

FUNDING

Research Grant, Canadian International Development Centre and the Aga Khan Foundation (administered by the Central Asian University), \$8,000.00

Postdoctoral Research Fellowship Grant, Economic and Social Research Council, UK Research and Innovation, The Government of the United Kingdom, £110,000.00

PhD Bursary (small grant), University College London, £500.00

John F. Richards Travel Fellowship, The American Institute of Afghanistan Studies, \$2,000.00

Conference Fund, University College London, £1000.00

Fully Paid Undergraduate Scholarship (merit-based), The Indian Council for Cultural Relations, Government of India, ₹304,000.00

TEACHING PROFILE

French academic teaching qualification – economic science section 2026 – (Qualifié aux fonctions de maître de conférences – Section 05), Conseil National Universitaire

Associate Fellow, Advance HE (formerly the UK Higher Education Academy) 2024 –

LANGUAGES

Persian Native

English Advanced

French Advanced (B2)

Urdu/Hindi Intermediate

Pashtu Intermediate

COMPUTER

R Studio, NVivo, Text Analysis, MS Office Tools, Virtual Learning Technologies

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS	Presentation of IMF project results on postwar Afghanistan, 18th European International Studies Association (EISA) Pan-European Conference on International Relations, University of Bologna, Bologna, Italy	2025
	Presentation on "Minimalist economic management, deferred revenue regime and aid dependency," 17th EISA Pan-European Conference on International Relations, Catholic University of Lille, Lille, France	2024
	Paper on informal institutions and uncertainty mitigation in the emerging private sector, International Initiative for Promoting Political Economy (IIPPE), King Juan Carlos University, Madrid, Spain	2023
	Presentation on the contradiction in postwar state-building objectives, UNU-WIDER / EU Commission Conference on Development Cooperation Effectiveness, Brussels, Belgium	2022
	Presentation on embodied institutions and adaptation strategies of manufacturing firms, Second Afghanistan Studies Conference, Afghanistan Centre at Kabul University, Kabul	2019
	Presentation on business adaptation strategies in times of instability, Afghanistan Inside Out: History, Culture and Politics in Afghanistan Studies, Afghanistan Centre at Kabul University, Kabul	2018
	Paper on embodied institutions in the Afghan market economy, Sussex Afghanistan Forum, University of Sussex, Brighton, United Kingdom	2018
	Paper on informal institutions, social capital, and manufacturing sector development, International Initiative for Promoting Political Economy (IIPPE), Berlin School of Economics and Law, Germany	2017
INVITED SEMINARS	Presentation on trade routes in conflict contexts, Silk Cities International Conference, University College London, United Kingdom	2017
	Workshop participant, Afghanistan Programme Research Conference, Raoul Wallenberg Institute, Lund University, Berlin, Germany	2025
	Workshop participant, Consultation Round Regarding Swiss Peace Research on Afghan Women and Civil Society in Consultative Processes, Swiss Peace (online)	2025
	Panellist, 2nd Conference on National Dialogue; Role of Civil Society, Women, and the Future of Afghanistan	2023

	Panellist on economic governance in Afghanistan, U.S. Institute of Peace, American Institute of Afghanistan Studies, University of Pittsburgh, Pittsburgh, USA	2023
	Panel moderator on national dialogue and the role of civil society in Afghanistan, National Center for Dialogue & Progress, Geneva, Switzerland	2022
	Panel moderator on Qatar's role in U.S.-Taliban negotiations, Afghanistan Institute of Strategic Studies, online	2022
	Panel participant on alternative scenarios for Afghanistan's future, Center for Global Affairs, New York University, online	2022
INVITED FELLOWSHIPS	Visiting Doctoral Fellow , Afghanistan Research and Evaluation Unit, Kabul, Afghanistan	2018
PEER REVIEW	<i>Journal of Intervention and Statebuilding</i>	2026 –
CONTINUED PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT	IBM Data Analyst Professional Certificate , IBM Skills Network (online)	2026 –
	Political Economy of Production and Labour (spring school), Scuola Normale Superiore, Florence, Italy	2026
	HEA Fellowship , Durham University Centre for Academic Development, Durham, UK	2023 – 2024
	Postdoctoral Fellows Professional Development Programme , UKRI Economic and Social Research Council, London, UK	2022 – 2023
	Academic Writing Workshop , The British Academy	2021
	Doctoral Skills Development Programme , University College London Doctoral School, London, UK Courses: a) statistical concepts in research, b) research methods for quantitative data, c) SPSS, d) responsible research & innovation, e) introduction to qualitative thematic analysis, f) working with archives, g) NVivo	2017 – 2019
CONSULTANCY	Contributor , S&P Global Area of focus: Europe Strasbourg, France	2026 –

	International Consultant , UN Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (remote) - Reviewed (under two contracts) quantitative pilot studies on education services in Afghanistan, evidence, structure and narrative flow - Ensured quality evidence, structure, narrative flow, balanced and objective conclusions with actionable recommendations	2024 – 2025
	Consultant , SOAS University Enterprise Office, London, UK Consultation round with the head of UNICEF for Afghanistan	2022
	Economic Advisor , Ministry of Economy, Republic of Afghanistan, Kabul, Afghanistan - Formulated a policy roadmap for UN Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) implementation in Afghanistan - Helped finalise an import substitution strategy	2018 – 2019
ADMINISTRATIVE AND OTHER	Member of ‘Widening Participation Group’ EDI initiative , School of Government and International Affairs, Durham University, Durham, UK Supported higher education in underrepresented schools in Durham County	2023 – 2024
	Coordinator , The Bartlett Faculty of the Built Environment, University College London, London, UK - Coordinated the establishment of a think tank (Global Change Initiative) at UCL’s Bartlett Faculty. - Organised debates, forums, and conferences, managing logistics and communication with guest speakers.	2017
	Research Assistant , EastWest Institute Economic Security Initiative, Washington, D.C., US - Contributed toward the finalisation and release of a study on trade connectivity in Central and South Asia - Contributed articles to the EastWest Institute blog	2014
	Assistant , Permanent Mission of Afghanistan to the United Nations, New York, US - Covered and reported on UN Security Council and Economic and Social Council meetings - Participated in negotiations on the United Nations counter-terrorism financing strategy	2014
ACADEMIC FACILITATOIN	Organiser , Windsor Policy Simulation Workshop, Bartlett Development Planning Unit, University College London, London, UK	2017

Organiser, UCL Global Citizenship Programme, Bartlett Development Planning Unit, University College London, London, UK 2017

POLICY BRIEFS

Rafi, K. (Ed.). (2025). Project to improve the quality and reach of the accelerated non-formal education programme (ANEP) [Unpublished manuscript]. Endline Evaluation, United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.

Rafi, K. (Ed.). (2025). Non-formal education provision to youth & adults for community rebuilding & resilience in earthquake-affected areas [Unpublished manuscript]. Endline Evaluation, United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.

Rafi, K. (Ed.). (2024). Adult literacy assessment survey [Unpublished manuscript]. Pilot Study Report, United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.

Rafi, K. (Ed.). (2024). Assessment of the youth and adult literacy and basic education model [Unpublished manuscript]. Report, United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization.

Rafi, K. (2019). Afghanistan Sustainable Development Goals Vision 2021–2030 [Unpublished manuscript]. Policy Brief, Ministry of Economy, Government of the Islamic Republic of Afghanistan.

MEDIA ARTICLES

All articles available on the following website: kambaizrafi.net

PERSONAL INTERESTS

Philosophy, sports (football and running), board games, British pub culture, fine arts (over four years of formal training), Persian poetry, and museums